

The asset *pack.*

What was the same for everyone on Saturday, written down so you can use it without me in the room.

Claude for entrepreneurs

Saturday 22 August 2026 · CHIPS, Gardens

YOUR OWN SKILL ISN'T IN HERE

On purpose. Everyone's was written live off whatever had just worked, so they're all different and they live on your laptop, not mine. Handing you a generic one back would be worse than useless.

What's in here instead is how to rebuild it, extend it, or write the next one — page 4.

What's in here

Five things. The first one is the one that decides whether any of this survives the fortnight.

1 Project instructions — a template

A text file to paste into your Project and fill in, plus the list of what to load in beside it. This is the one to do first.

2 The prompt library

Eighteen prompts that did real work on the day, grouped by what they're for. Not a list of clever tricks — the ones you'll actually reach for.

3 Writing your own skill

The interview questions, the rules that separate a skill that works from one that gets ignored, and the no-file way to install it.

4 The cheat sheet

The same one from Saturday. Where every screen lives, and what to do when something breaks.

5 The workshop skill

The zip you installed as pre-work. Keep it — it's how you pick up any station you want to run again.

DO ONE THING

Not three. The people this works for are the ones who used it on the Monday, not the ones with the longest list. If you only do one thing out of this pack, fill in the Project instructions and put your real documents behind them.

The 14-day call is Friday 4 September, 10:00, online. One win and one blocker each. Come with something you actually tried, even if it broke — especially if it broke.

The prompt *library*

Everything here either did real work on Saturday or is the prompt somebody needed and didn't have. Nothing aspirational.

BRIEFING INSTEAD OF PROMPTING

“Here's what I'm trying to achieve, here's my business, here's the actual file, and here's how I'd know it was done properly. Ask me what's missing before you start.”

The whole of block 3 in one line. The last sentence is the part people leave off, and it's the part that saves the round trip.

“Before you answer, tell me what you'd need from me to do this properly.”

Use it when an answer comes back thin. Nine times out of ten the problem was the brief, not the model.

“That's not it. Here's what's wrong with it, specifically.”

Correcting is faster than re-prompting. Say what's wrong rather than asking again in different words.

WORKING WITH YOUR OWN FILES

“Here's the export. Before you analyse anything, tell me what's in it — what each column means, what the row count is, and what looks wrong or inconsistent.”

Always do this first with a file you haven't used before. Every real-world export has a trap in it and this is how you find it before it's baked into a number.

“What in this file would give me a wrong answer if I wasn't careful?”

Blanks that mean 'not applicable' rather than zero, repeated rows, totals mixed in with detail. Ask it directly.

“Reconcile your total against the total in the file itself, and tell me if they don't match.”

The single most useful sentence in this library if you work with numbers. Never accept a figure that hasn't been checked against something the file already says.

MAKING IT A REAL THING

“Don't give me this in the chat. Make it a file I can open and send.”

Spreadsheet, document, deck, page. Chat text isn't a deliverable and asking is all it takes.

“Build it so I can change the assumptions and everything updates.”

The difference between a number and a model. Ask for it explicitly or you'll get a snapshot.

“Now change one assumption and show me what it does to the answer.”

This is the moment it stops being a document and starts being a tool. Do it once and you'll never accept a static file again.

GETTING IT TO SOUND LIKE YOU

“Here are three things I've actually written. Use these, not a professional register.”

Real samples beat any amount of describing your tone. Raw is better than polished — send the WhatsApp, not the press release.

“Read that back and tell me which parts sound like a machine wrote them. Then fix those.”

Works better than asking it to 'sound more human', which produces a different kind of machine.

“Shorter. Take out anything I wouldn't say out loud.”

The most-used prompt in the room on Saturday, by a distance.

MAKING IT REPEAT

“That worked. Write it up as a skill so I can do it again next month without explaining it.”

Say this the moment something works, while the steps are still in front of you. That's how every skill in the room got made.

“Every Monday at 07:00, do this and send me three lines and what I should do about it.”

You never need a menu to set up a schedule — just ask. The three lines matter: a scheduled job that writes an essay gets ignored inside a fortnight.

“Run it once now so I can see what Monday will actually look like.”

Fire it immediately rather than waiting a week to discover it's wrong.

WHEN YOU'RE STUCK

“Tell me what you think I'm actually trying to do here, before you do anything.”

Cheapest way to catch a wrong turn. If its answer surprises you, that's the problem found.

“What's the simplest version of this that would still be useful to me on Monday?”

For when the thing you asked for has grown three heads.

“What am I not asking you that I should be?”

Worth running at the end of any real piece of work.

Writing your own *skill*

Yours evolved in the room and it's yours to keep going. This is how to rebuild it, extend it, or write the next one — and there will be a next one, because the second is always easier than the first.

TWO KINDS, AND THEY'RE NOT THE SAME JOB

- A **voice skill** teaches Claude how you write. Name it after *you* — **sarah-voice**, not **company-voice**. You'll run more than one business; your voice moves with you.
- A **process skill** teaches Claude a job you do over and over. Name it after *the job* — **month-end-pack**, **weekly-numbers**, **client-quote** — because that's what you'll look for when you want it.

THE INTERVIEW, IF YOU'RE DOING A VOICE SKILL

Answer these in a chat and ask Claude to turn them into a skill.

1. What's the business, and what do you actually sell?
2. Who's the customer? The specific person who signs, not a category
3. What have you built before?
4. Who are you usually writing to?
5. What's your sign-off?
6. What makes you cringe when you see it in your own writing?
7. Do you write in more than one language? Say so, and say that you mix English business terms in. That's authentic — don't let it tidy that away
8. **Paste in two or three things you've actually written.** An email, a WhatsApp to a client, a LinkedIn post.
Raw beats polished

Question 8 is worth more than the other seven put together. A single real email beats a paragraph of describing yourself.

WHAT SEPARATES ONE THAT WORKS FROM ONE THAT GETS IGNORED

- **Quote your actual sentences.** Five real phrases beat any amount of adjectives
- **Be specific about what to avoid.** "Don't be corporate" is useless. "Never open with *I hope this email finds you well*" is something it can act on
- **Say when it should fire.** The description is all Claude sees when deciding whether to use it, so list the situations
- **Keep it under 150 lines.** Long ones get skimmed, sharp ones get followed
- **Invent nothing.** Leave out what you don't know. A blank section invites it to make something up

INSTALLING IT WITHOUT TOUCHING A FILE

You can't zip a file without a terminal, and you don't need to. Open a new chat and say: "*Create a skill for me from this*", then paste the text in. Claude builds and installs it in the conversation. That's the whole thing — the upload route is for when someone hands you a file.

Test it on the real job, immediately. Not a demo of it — the actual thing you need to write or run this week. There will be something to fix, there always is, usually that it's too long or it invented a step you don't do. Fix it once and it's done. It's a text file you own, and you can change it whenever the business does.